Native checkpoints for the dense closure: stop, kill, resume

Date: 2026-10-24. Code: `src/cryptanalysis/closure_checkpoint.rs`, `inherited_f4.rs` (`close_with`, `ClosureSink`), `gf2_elim.rs` (`rref_resumable`), `examples/dreg_closure.rs` (`--checkpoint-dir`). Driver: `../../ckpt-validate.sh`. Graph source: `plot.py`. Raw outputs: `data/`.

This report records observations. It reaches no verdict about any hypothesis, and it makes no timing claim: runs that were stopped and resumed are not cold measurements.

What ran

Every run is `dreg_closure --to 4 --max-cols 1100000 --draw K FILE`, the dense closure scan at degrees 3 and 4 on a committed draw of `research/dreg_closure_scale_20261016/draws/`, on one 4-core, 15 GB container.

Cell m=4 (12,3), draw 1 (`data/m4-12-3-d1/`, `ckpt-validate.sh`, nothing else running):

run	segments	saves	GB written	s in saves	wall s (first / last segment)	9 fields equal plain
plain (no checkpoint)	1	0	0	0	44	(reference)
checkpoint every 5 s, never stopped	1	14	15.9	58	103 / 103	yes
SIGTERM at 25 s, resumed	2	16	19.4	67	35 / 81	yes
SIGKILL at 25 s, resumed	2	15	17.6	61	25 / 96	yes

Compared per degree: `degree, xl_refuted, closure_refuted, saturated, xl_rank, closure_rank, columns, closure_products, closure_word_ops`. `secs` is excluded: it is the compute time summed over segments. The checkpoint interval was 5 s, chosen to force many saves on a 44 s run; the largest state is 2.5 GB (303,065 rows × 1,038 words).

Cell m=4 (13,4), draw 1 (`data/m4-13-4-d1/`): segment 1 was stopped by `timeout 280`, which sends SIGTERM, while round 5′s elimination was at word 180 of 1,943 with 11,520 of 287,231 rows pivoted. It wrote generation 6 (4.47 GB, 27.2 s) and exited 143. Segment 2 restored generation 6 and finished. Result: closure degree 4, 124,314 columns, 700,747 products, 717,930,505,315 word operations, in both the resumed and the plain run (all nine fields equal). These runs shared the 4 cores with a compile, so their wall times (plain 415 s; segments 308 s + 132 s) are indicative only (`data/m4-13-4-d1/walls.txt`).

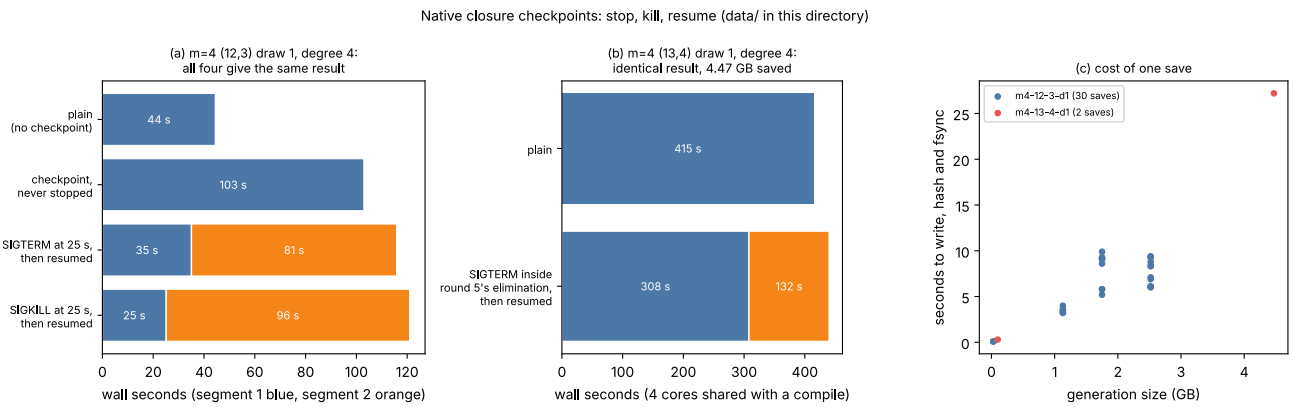


Figure 1: Stop, kill, resume: wall seconds, and the cost of one save. Data in `data/`, source `plot.py`.

Observations

- Measured: the three checkpointed runs on (12,3) and the stopped-and-resumed run on (13,4) have the same value as the plain run in every compared field, including the word-operation counter.
- Measured: with a 5 s interval the uninterrupted checkpointed run took 103 s against 44 s plain; 58 s of that is inside 14 saves of up to 2.5 GB each. At the workflow's 3600 s interval the same save cost is paid once an hour. Derived: one save writes, hashes and fsyncs about 0.3–0.4 GB/s here (2.5 GB in 6–9 s; panel c), so a 200 GB state would take about 8–11 minutes on this disk. The cluster's disk is not measured.
- Measured: a SIGKILL 25 s into the run left the generations committed so far; the next process restored the newest valid one and finished. Loss was the work since that save.
- Measured: a first attempt at this validation failed with `No space left on device`: committing a generation before pruning needed three states on disk at the peak. Pruning to one committed generation before writing the next makes

the peak two states; the failed save was not recoverable then and a failed periodic save is now logged and retried instead of ending the run. The numbers above are from the corrected build.
- Derived, from the unit tests (see `../../CHECKPOINTS.md`): stopping at every word boundary of the elimination kernel and resuming reproduces the matrix, rank and charged word operations exactly; a scan stopped after every round, and inside eliminations, equals the plain scan on 9 chained systems; a broken restore of the pending falls fails the round-resume and fallback tests, and a broken restore position of the elimination makes the second never finish (the mutated build did not terminate).

Limits

- One draw per cell; two small cells. Not measured: any state above 4.5 GB, S3 transfer, a node loss.
- Not covered by a checkpoint: the plain (XL) elimination and the Macaulay matrix build and first elimination of the closure (before round 0). A loss there repeats that step.
- Wall times are those of a shared 4-core container and say nothing about the cluster.